

Booking & Appointment Portal - User Guide

Taking bookings on the portal, from the customer's side and the business owner's, with the demo admin sign-in.

Revision 1 - July 2026 | Abdikarim, Frontend Developer & Freelancer

Where to go

Booking portal

<https://ratiba-blush.vercel.app>

Customer booking pages and the owner's dashboard behind one address.

Sign-in details

Admin

Email: abdkarimochieng@gmail.com
Password: MyNewPassword123

Sign in with these details to reach the owner dashboard - services, availability and bookings.

Customer

Account: Not required - book as a guest

Customers can book without registering. Creating an account only adds a place to see and manage past bookings.

Please read: These are shared demo accounts on a public deployment. Anyone reading this guide can sign in with them, so treat everything inside as throwaway sample data: do not enter real names, phone numbers, ID numbers or live payment details. Passwords are rotated from time to time - if one stops working, get in touch and I will send the current set.

1. What the portal is for

Any business that sells someone's time - a salon, a clinic, a garage, a consultant - spends a surprising amount of the day on the phone arranging when. This portal moves that online: the business publishes its services and its working hours, and customers pick a slot that is genuinely free.

It is built as a SaaS product, so a business signs up, configures its own services and staff, and gets its own booking page, without anything being set up by hand.

- Booking pages - what a customer sees: services, real availability, and a short form.
- Dashboard - what the owner sees: the day's diary, upcoming appointments and customer records.
- Services and availability - the settings that decide which slots are ever offered.

2. Booking as a customer

1. Open the portal address and choose the service you want. Each one shows how long it takes and what it costs.
2. Pick a date. The calendar only offers days the business is open.
3. Pick a time. Only genuinely free slots are shown - anything already booked is gone from the list rather than shown and then refused.
4. Fill in your name, phone number and email, and add a note if there is anything the business should know.
5. Confirm. You get a booking reference on screen and a confirmation message.

Keep the booking reference. It is what you need to check, reschedule or cancel without an account.

3. Changing or cancelling a booking

1. Open the manage-booking link from your confirmation, or enter your reference on the portal.
2. Choose Reschedule to move it - you get the same availability calendar, and the old slot is released as the new one is taken.
3. Choose Cancel to drop it. The slot goes straight back into the pool for other customers.

Where the business has set a cutoff - say, no changes within two hours of the appointment - the option is closed off past that point and you are asked to call instead.

4. Signing in as the administrator

The admin side is behind its own sign-in, separate from the customer booking pages.

1. Open the portal and go to the admin sign-in.
2. Enter the email and password from the credentials table at the front of this guide.
3. Submit. You land on the dashboard.

5. Setting up services

Services are the foundation. A slot can only ever be offered because a service defines how long it takes, so this is the first screen to visit on a new account.

1. Open Services from the dashboard.
2. Add a service with its name, description, duration and price.
3. Add any buffer needed either side - cleaning up, resetting a room, writing notes - so back-to-back bookings do not run into each other.
4. Save. The service appears on the customer booking page immediately.

6. Working hours and availability

1. Open availability or working hours from the dashboard.
2. Set the opening and closing time for each day of the week, and mark the days you are closed.
3. Block out one-off dates - public holidays, leave, a full-day booking elsewhere. Blocked dates disappear from the customer calendar.
4. Save. Availability recalculates from your hours, your service durations and the bookings already taken.

Slots are worked out at the moment a customer looks, not stored in advance. That is why a slot someone else just took vanishes from your calendar on refresh, and why the same time can never be sold twice.

7. Running the day

1. Open the dashboard for today's diary in order of time.
2. Click an appointment for the customer's details, the service booked and any note they left.
3. Mark it confirmed, completed, cancelled or a no-show as the day goes on.
4. Add a walk-in or a phone booking directly from the dashboard - it takes the same slot check as an online one, so nothing gets double-booked.
5. Use the customer list to see someone's history before they arrive.

8. If something goes wrong

- A customer says no slots are available - check the working hours for that day, and check the date is not blocked out.
- A slot disappeared while booking - someone else took it. Pick another; the calendar refreshes on its own.
- A booking is missing from the diary - check the date filter, and check it was not cancelled. Cancelled bookings are hidden by default rather than deleted.
- You cannot sign in - the demo password is rotated periodically. Get in touch for the current set.